

Workbook – Lesson
Healing the Inner Child 1

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301-4 – Healing the Inner Child 1

Presented By: Cheryl O'Neil

Inner child work is an effective and highly relied upon therapeutic technique for many hypnotherapists. In this two-part certification course, you will learn how to identify and connect with the hurt inner child in the subconscious mind of your adult client. Cheryl O'Neil, CCHt, will guide you in the skills set of using inner child imagery work for freeing the client from the limiting and negative impacts of a hurt inner child. This class provides two group imagery experiences.

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Workbook - Healing the Inner Child 1

AHA Certification Course

This 3-Part Certification Course will qualify you as a **Certified Specialist in Healing the Inner Child** with the American Hypnosis Association (AHA).

1. Healing the Inner Child Part 1 (301-4)
2. Healing the Inner Child Part 2 (301-5)
3. Healing the Inner Child Case History Series and Certification (Coming Soon)

You must successfully complete the above, including all quizzes, to receive your AHA "Healing the Inner Child" certificate, which can be found in your Certificates of Completion from your Student Menu.

Learning Objectives

As you complete this learning area, you should be proficient in the following areas:

Knowledge

- Clues to recognize the adult client with a hurt inner child (IC) perspective.
- Adult hurt inner child sensitivities effect on E&P Way of Being.
- Hypnotherapy and imagery IC strategy variations.

Comprehension

- Fundamentals of the client who is grown and did not grow up.
- Fundamentals of how to build a positive subconscious system of adult inner strength.

Application

- Advanced approach to IC client.
- Ready to connect the IC strategy with the positive hypnotic dimension in Class 2.

Learning Approach

The recommended approach to learning is to:

- Refer to the workbook for this lesson while watching the lecture, taking notes as needed.
- Review your notes, Workbook pages, and class streaming videos.
- Complete the open-book quiz.
- Practice the techniques covered in this class.

Resources

- Your Class Lecture
- Workbook and Notes
- Class PowerPoint (PDF, 11 Pages)

Workbook Table of Contents

1. Adult Client with a Subconscious Hurt Child Image
2. Hypnotherapy Transformational Process
3. When to Use Inner Child Image
4. Hypnotherapy Strategy for Inner Child (IC)
5. Hypnotherapist Tip Sheet – Spot Light

Adult Client with a Subconscious Hurt Child Image

Negative Alert Without End

Since they were a kid, they knew. They looked forward and dreamed big dreams and all kinds of delights, imagined adventures, a life of daring-do, where anything is possible and ever-flows a fount of joys, creativity, discovery, exploration, play, enthusiasm, boldness, audacity, intuition, inquisitiveness, silliness, spirit, bounce-back, eagerness. It is the way of innocence. Emo feeling secure freedom, and Phys feeling love infinite. In that swirl of positive unlimited comes the sense, vision, or image of who they are – who they are uniquely supposed to be. Stuck in bad circumstances, a child may just take all that good stuff and more and hide it away in the innermost self. It is the defense strategy of a hurt child on emergency alert.

Stuck in a fearsome situation, where uncertainty abounds, and calamity unpredictably comes and goes, with no rescue in sight – a child is going to try and handle it as best they can. It is amazing and baffling how a little child on the planet, in such a short time, comes up with some way to survive awful circumstances. Brilliant really. Their situation is inexplicable and inescapable – and in some kind of way, a child comes up with a system that gets them through it and preserves many of the good and valuable things about themselves and about living. Their hopes and dreams for security, love, accomplishment, and goals – all still alive within – are kept safe by their ingenious childhood system.

It is the system of a child. Put in place without expiration date. Devised in distress, without life skills, without inner independence, without positive suggestions, without inner strengthening, without desensitizing the fear, the unfairness, and the hurt. Bye-bye strength within, self-assurance, confidence, trust, positive beliefs, and expectations. They can remain ever-hurt, ever-fearful. Locked in the past, protecting themself ever on full alert, ever responding and reacting from within the hurt child negative system. The subconscious helps by being on the lookout for more of the same. The hurt child image is seeing through the eyes of the past. Leaving the client open to all negative, potentially negative, maybe might be negative, and even positive is probably negative, things going on in their life, in the world, in the universe. If it is negative, it pertains to them, and it can affect them; everything negative is personal. It is suggestibility, receptivity, maybe hyper-suggestibility, or perhaps even somnambulism – an ongoing negative overload all the time.

Hypnotherapy Transformational Process

From Negative to Positive

Negative feelings and emotions from the past can cloud the present. Here and now, the client finds they are reacting and behaving contrary to what they really want. With a system dominated by the feelings and expectations of a hurt, fearful child, how else can it go? Unfairly tagged as sabotaging their own life when what they are doing is not what they want – it just always goes that way. Bewilderingly urged to get with it, don't be a baby, grow up, to be responsible, accountable for their life, be grateful, be appreciative, be happy – they know all about that, and they would if they could.

Kappasinian hypnotherapists understand it is the subconscious, unaware of the passage of time and circumstances, responding automatically from habit learned long ago. Learned from the perspective of a frightened child, it is a system of fear and hurt. The subconscious is their biggest protector and sincerest supporter; while trying to help, instead holds them back or reacts all wrong for what is going on in the present. The adult client's conscious already wants it. They want something better. They feel like they cannot get there.

It all stems from what they are receptive to and to what they have learned. Kappasinian Mind Theory recognized that whatever is learned can be unlearned, and new positive knowns can be acquired.

The subconscious learns anew through hypnotic suggestion and imagery. The repetition of positive suggestions in the hypnotic state increases the subconscious association to a new way. The positives come to override the negatives. The client comes to respond to life from their positively fortified bank of knowns.

Let loose from the limiting restraints of their past, the client unfurls their hopes and dreams – some long familiar, some new surprising. Stoked by an imagination robust on positive belief and positive expectation. They go for it. Ascend the heights to seek the kind of life they always knew or hoped or wished was out there for them. Their conscious and subconscious in harmonious, unified positive focus essential for the resilience, the bounce-back that a mended heart needs to go ever onward, come what may.

Negative System

- Aggravated
- Anxious
- Stressed
- Stuck
- Fearful
- Angry
- Resentful
- Sadness
- Not Enough
- Not Good Enough

Positive System

- Peaceful
- Comfortable
- Heartened

- Solid In Charge
- Courage
- Enjoyment
- Strength
- Happiness
- Self-Acceptance
- Self-Value

Easy to choose. No one consulting a hypnotherapist is wanting help to feel more stuck in life. They do not want to feel more afraid, more hostile, more bitter, or more dismal. They are not seeking to feel even more little, more dependent, or more put upon. Those are the unpleasant, disagreeable feelings, the dead-end, no exit way for a negative system.

The client wants to feel at liberty to go forward in life. They want to feel more inner fortification, more sure, more lighthearted, and more carefree. They are seeking the way to more bounce-back, more determination, and more imperturbable inner independence. They want the upbeat, expansive, feeling good feelings, of a wide open, go for it positive system.

When to Use Inner Child Image

Adult Client without Adult Inner Strength for Living

There are those with receptibility, which gives them an optimistic resilience in bad and good times – irrepressibly positive. However dark the ordeal of childhood – they were not receptive to the negatives of it; they have the subconscious habit of positizing anything and everything.

The hypnotherapy client is one who was receptive to the dispiriting negatives of it and now, as an adult, wants out. They want another way than the stuck, fearful, angry, pessimistic, expect the worst, anxious, gloomy way that comes with a negative subconscious system forged in a childhood of hurt.

The effects of a subconscious hurt child image comes out in different ways. Maybe the client asks to make some kind of child within or inner child or child part connection. It is not always that simple. Sometimes, it shows up wrapped up inside the client story. Maybe the client says they are stopped from being themselves, held back from going for it, not doing what they want. Perhaps the client describes it as something little within is stopping them, and they want to end the reign of that something little.

Sometimes, a client may say they want to get past childhood trauma. Good time for the hypnotherapist to ask have they worked with a licensed professional on that. Maybe they have, and maybe not. It could be appropriate to ask for a referral before getting into the Inner Child healing experience.

Perhaps, in working with your client, there is discovery of needing inner child healing due to connecting to the subconscious in prior sessions. This may vary depending on out-of-scope issues as to whether to suggest doing a few sessions with a licensed psychotherapist – and then again getting a referral.

A client may be getting what they want out of life, but the problems are about how they are reacting and responding to life situations good times and bad. They want others to change so they can feel okay. A client wants someone, anyone, to fix it for them whatever it is, wants someone, anyone to make them feel safe and secure. They all want to feel better. They all want to have their life.

Feeling and Behavior Clues

The hurt to a child is so inexplicable, unfair, wrong, and unpredictable. At the deepest level, they felt fear then; they feel fear now. It might well leave them in a hyper-suggestible or overwhelmed somnambulistic state. As long as the client goes to their old subconscious hurt child beliefs, feelings, and behaviors, their automatic known responses to life and living will kick in and run their life.

- Easily downhearted
- Easily fearful
- Easily angry
- Easily discouraged
- Easily hurt
- Lingering sadness
- Disappointed in happiness
- Disappointed no one really cares
- Betrayed again
- Blames self
- Blames others

- Fears being at fault
- Justified indignation
- Argumentative
- Goes along out of fear
- Hyper-alert
- Painful envy
- Resentment
- Anticipates negatives
- Negative viewpoint
- Wants others to be in charge
- Annoyed with whoever is in charge
- Receptive to guilt
- Receptive to shame
- Emo hopeless insecurity
- Phys rejection everywhere
- Connects present problems with bad childhood
- Feelings of being trapped or limited by childhood
- Seem to be in hypnosis, with dulled feelings about childhood
- Sadness and anger about how they were treated as a child
- Longing for the emotional support that they did not get as a child
- Feeling misunderstood, or not heard, or not seen as a child
- Abandoned by one or both parents as a child
- Feels they were criticized too much as a child
- The wish for a better childhood
- Lingering fear that seeks justification
- Protection should come from somewhere out there
- As a child, they felt unwanted, pushed aside, a problem, or a bother; their very existence was trouble
- Seem to be little in relation to others, all of whom are big
- Client may want the hypnotherapist to tell them what to do or what to say to others
- Everyone else had it better

Client Statement Clues

- My brother has so much money, and he’s not even a good person – and I work so hard, and I want it so much, and look at me, what have I got – he always had it easier.
- I give up! I got a promotion at work, so my mother goes, "Well, I guess I didn’t do so bad after all."
- I was never a child. I was raised by babies. I took care of them.
- I had to take care of myself.
- I haven’t spoken to my parents for years; now I’m stuck taking care of them.
- I think I should be doing my dream, but I’m afraid.
- It shouldn’t have been that way; it’s not fair.

- Everything I do gets ruined.
- There’s a little me inside stopping big me.

Over and Done Clues

- I get it. She was a single mom. She wasn’t angry at me; she was just afraid.
- I divorced my father a long time ago. I’m done with all that.
- They probably did the best they could.
- It was a long time ago.
- I already made peace with it.
- I’ve worked through all my childhood stuff.

When the childhood hurt stories come with assurance from the client that they are over it and seem laced with a blamey anger, roadblock upset, lingering sadness, subversive suffering, or any of the insidious stressful negatives – there’s probably more to it, and it’s likely their subconscious is not over-it – and is still living it.

Hypnotherapy Strategy for Inner Child (IC)

Conscious Positive Support

A hypnotherapy therapeutic plan always includes helping to create mutual support between the conscious goals and intentions, and subconscious beliefs and expectations.

- **The Positive Two Step:** Handwrite on paper

  Emo

  - Step One – 5 positive experiences
  - Step Two – 5 personal positives

  Phys

  - Step One – 5 positives you like about life
  - Step Two – 5 positives you like about yourself

- **Write a letter to Inner Child:**
  - Client makes a handwritten connection to Inner Child
  - Inner Child hand writes back with non-dominate hand
- **Future Forward:** Handwrite on paper
  - What do you want to accomplish?
  - Describe it
  - What's it like to have it?
  - What is the one thing to do today about it?
- **Mental Bank:** Handwrite positive affirmations each night before sleep to build positive self-encouragement

  Emo

  - More and more secure, more and more reassured
  - More and more becoming comfortable being in the flow
  - The unexpected positive happens

  Phys

  - I am confident
  - I love giving, and I love receiving
  - I can do it

- **One Fun:**
  - Handwrite a positive, fun-filled leisure idea to enjoy
  - Take the leap – do something just for the positive fun of it

Subconscious Positive Support

The subconscious runs on expectation and imagination. It does not know the difference between fact or fantasy. It is the timeless land of belief and feelings. Repetition of beliefs and feelings forms a system. Beliefs do not come from facts. Beliefs and feelings are all mixed up together in the subconscious. Imagery is the way into the subconscious.

The mind the brain learns in images. Good fortune.

It is by images that hypnosis and imagery reach the client's deeper mind. And now, with a hypnotherapist to help, the repetition of images that build belief and feeling are new positives, affirmative of the adult client's hopes, dreams, and goals. With the flood of new positive images, the client's subconscious gets it. The new positives eventually overwhelm the old negatives. New beliefs and feelings form the client's positive subconscious system. Ever I like it.

How to Build a Positive Subconscious System

4 Essentials for Accomplishment

- Strong Desire
- Belief
- Positive Expectation
- Self-Demand

12 Essentials for Positizing

- Inner Strength
- Self-Acceptance
- Self-Approval
- Self-Trust
- Self-Value
- Personal Freedom
- Self-Reliance
- Self-Love
- Self-Determination
- Self-Positive
- Ever I Like It
- Inner Independence

Benefits

- Way less resistance.
- Much better connection with self and others.
- Looks through eyes of the here and now rather than through the hurt eyes of the past.

Plus –

- A positive I like it subconscious feels good. I like it feels Emo calm and secure. Phys relaxed and confident. It is everything's going to be okay. Everything turns out to the positive – and that is Kappasinian.

Hypnotherapist Know-How

Adult IC Client

When looking through eyes of the past from the hurt child perspective into the here and now, the vision is so clouded, it is almost trance like, because the hurt is tainting anything and everything. Nothing is seen for what it really is; everything is slightly cockeyed and yet not known to be so. Familiar piles of stuff become hoarding; chaos all around is comfort, what others say or do is continually suspect, and interpretations of what is or is not are wildly fantasized. It's an upside-down world where north is south and south is north; everything is opposite, and opposites rule the day. Yet, it all feels so right to them.

What to Do

- Sudden, abrupt, quick alteration of long-held negative subconscious beliefs and feelings can be a perilous endeavor. Taking a gradual, unhurried way allows the client's inmost self to take in the new positives, building up and ever up without disturbing the old path. The old path eventually fades as the new path becomes a trusted way.
- It's not our job to tell the client they have a cockeyed viewpoint. The process is not a direct taking away of their solid upside-down system. Waking up the client to the here and now is almost like de-hypnotizing them. From sessions of hypnotic imagery and suggestion, eventually, the old beliefs and feelings do drop away, and coming out of the trance of the past happens. As the new beliefs are being presented to the subconscious, and repeated, and eventually believed, the client is moving forward.
- Releasing the client from the hurt child image of the past takes debunking the negatives again and again in the hypnotic state. The hypnotherapist may also be ever reminding the client to count themselves out to help the client be more present in the conscious state and less likely to be hyper-suggestible.
- Helping the client to deal with the hurt feelings does not mean regressing them or taking them through the trauma again in any way.
- It does mean, for the adult IC client, making a subconscious connection with the hurt inner child image and supplying it with what has been lacking. In some cases, the hypnotherapist may be the first one to hear about the client's hurt child feelings. Listen with compassion, kindness, and understanding. Hold space for them to reveal.
- Coming out of the negative spell, the adult IC client learns to give to the hurt inner child image what it needs and wants: compassion, understanding, appreciation, love, value, worthiness, trust, and more.
- Then it's all about Inner Strengthening. Building up some new positive knowns to be present to live right now, to develop goals and start accomplishing them, and to enjoy life and living.
- The adult IC client may also begin to find hidden treasures that had been squirreled away for safekeeping out of the old hurt days – dreams, desires, and talents come to the surface in surprising ways.

Inner Strengthening

Lost in the wilderness of childhood victimy, an adult IC client still carrying the baggage of that negative emotion does not have an effective way to meet Life on Life's terms. Finding the way through depends upon making a subconscious connection to strengthen and build them up within. They are seeking your help because they have a desire, and now, with hypnosis and imagery that desire becomes strong desire.

- First, through imagery and suggestion, connect the client to their own true value, their pure essence of being, and help them to know that there is nobody else in the world just like them. They are uniquely special and have gifts to give and gifts to receive. Once this begins to occur, their desire to connect to more true value of self becomes stronger.
- This true value goes right along with finding an inner resource through imagery, like a Protector of some kind, who is always there for the client, ever with encouragement, kindness, and caring. This helps to fortify the client and build a deep inner feeling of connection needed to repair and restore the self.

- Supply the client with some inner mechanisms like anchors to words that bring images for Calm or Relax. This is part of the new learning for clients to help keep anxiety at bay. Overall, with more strength within, fear and anxiety dissipate.
- Desensitizing anxiety, stress, and fear, the client has more room to begin to believe in their desires, aspirations, goals, and to believe in themselves. To believe again that they can do it, they can achieve and accomplish. Backed by positive suggestion and imagery, new knowns are born, and positive beliefs then develop as the new positive system is being created.
- And now with more belief in this positive focus, add in positive expectation. Help the client again through imagery and suggestion to hold an expectation of the positive in their mind, no matter what, that everything and anything turns to the positive, without doubt certain! With new found qualities of determination, enthusiasm, and resilience, the client has a mindset that there is always a way, even if a thought of there is no way, a way just opens up.
- Now the client has a much better chance to be prepared to meet challenges as they come through the door, as well as enjoy their life all along the way. Oh, so good times or not so good times, the mindset is still with a positive focus. Seeing clearly through eyes of the here and now and into the future, every problem has a solution. Now the thinking, the receptivity, and the feelings are more solution oriented to have the experience, the beauty, the fullness of a valued and worthwhile life to live.
- The hypnotherapist, through this process of strengthening the client, also helps the client to develop the qualities of being willing to do whatever it takes, both consciously and subconsciously, to stay on the path, the path of their right direction.

Getting Through the Good Times

It is a kind of balancing the books. The client is getting stronger, responding in the new desired ways, and some good success may occur, and then suddenly, the client is thrown right back into an old behavior. The subconscious perhaps reverts to the comfort of an old known response. Most likely out of fear. The hypnotherapist reinvigorates the new knowns once again, perhaps some stronger desensitizing, ever encouraging the client to become comfortable with the new, comfortable with success, so it becomes the more regular known response or behavior. Strengthening allows them to live more easily with the good times.

Some Effects of Hurt Inner Child on E&P Way of Being

- Right out of the gate, when it comes to human connection, the adult IC client carries the burdens of the negative boggled start-up in life, and as they grow and yet do not become grown up, looking through hurt eyes of the past, their very connection to themselves is likely to be corrupted. And so is every other interaction with all people all the time likely to be corrupted in some kind of way. How people act, what they say, how they respond, think, and feel create a mysterious maze of unfair conundrums for the adult IC client to walk through leaving them in lack of Emo security and Phys safety.
- When an Emo IC client is looking through hurt eyes of the past, it may seem as though everything is against them. When a Phys IC client is looking through hurt eyes of the past: It may feel as though everyone is rejecting them. This puts relationships of all kinds at risk. The adult IC client who is looking through hurt eyes of the past might have troubles with the boss, co-worker, best friend, parent, significant other, inanimate object, anyone, or anything else that crosses their path.
- For no apparent reason – an Emo IC client may avoid using certain equipment, or suddenly shut down, or stop connecting with someone they always do connect with.
- It’s a mystery – a Phys IC client may give the cold shoulder, or start fights more often, even with the beep of a car horn blocks away, or rages out of control with a loved one.
- They end up acting in ways that are detrimental to what they really want, and they can’t see it, so certain they have been victimized again and probably reacted accordingly.

How to Handle

For the adult IC client perspective, one of the very first things to subconsciously receive is from this hypnotic suggestion: ***allow all others to own their own negativity, personal problems, or hang-ups. Become unaffected by the negativity, personal problems, or hangups of others – most importantly, your self-acceptance will depend less and less on others; you'll simply start liking yourself more, and taking better care of yourself.***

Helping the Emo IC Client

Loss of Security, real or imagined, brings up fear and anxiety. Security is the number one importance for Emo, and loss of it sends the Emo into a fearful tailspin. Bring the Emo into the hypnotic state and with imagery, and suggestion help the Emo to concentrate on the feeling of the end result when the problem is over, the feeling the Emo would really like to have, the positive feeling result. Once that is strongly felt, have them imagine bringing that feeling all the way back into the here and now, to presently thread that feeling into every step the Emo takes in present time. Giving Emo a mind anchor of calm may also be helpful.

Helping the Phys IC Client

Rejection brings up fear. Rejection is the number one fear for Phys, and often, when Phys is in rejection, they do not recognize it. It's important to help them understand about it, that Phys is creating their own feelings, and that it's important to not take things so personally. In hypnosis, use suggestions that boost self-value, self-approval, and self-confidence. Give Phys subconscious encouragement to make connections to life and living, connect to nature, spirituality, other people, places, and things that bring them positive upbeat feelings of connection. Connection instead of Rejection. A physical anchor such as a hand to the heart will also stimulate the love they have for making those good connections.

Scripts and Journeys

Stay tuned for the next class of Healing the Inner Child. The Class 2 Handbook gives ways to go with hypnosis scripts and imagery journeys for helping E&P IC clients find their way to a positive subconscious system.

Hypnotherapist Tip Sheet – Spot Light

E&P and Inner Child Image

- Both Emo and Phys clients will probably understand the idea of inner child image as a concept.
- Emo client responds to feelings mentally and may tend to go along with the idea, image, or symbol without thinking or feeling that a subconscious child image is some part of them. Phys client leads with feelings first and may tend to respond and feel the subconscious child image is some part of them.

Heads Up on Some Ways Client May Be

- The client may tell you their story with a lot of details, few details, add more later, may not provide specifics, ever. Their past story is not essential to helping them. The focus is on the client present future goal.
- Client may vent with anger, more force, than they actually mean or feel.
- Heavy burden of fear and hurt feelings, may pour out in intense waves of grief, in pre-talk, and in hypnosis.
- Client may be kerflummoxed, nonplused, a little surprised, disappointed, maybe stung, even angry that this thing can keep invading their life. Living through it was enough, and now it reaches its bony hand out of the past to try and grab the rest of their life.

Hypnotherapist Ever Positive Point of View

- Compassion from a hypnotherapist steadfast with a calm-cool-collected demeanor is reassuring to a hurt inner child image client.
- The hypnotherapist, with optimistic confidence in the client, gives important support and motivation. And more. Positive expectation for the client to succeed, motivates the hypnotherapist to excellence.

Hypnotherapist Overload

- Sometimes a hypnotherapist gets overloaded. It is important to block client negatives with hypnosis, preferably from another hypnotherapist or mentor.
- Revitalize with self-hypnosis, to release stress, release negatives, and renew positive outlook, commitment to purpose, enthusiasm, happiness, and refresh belief in positive potential for the client to achieve their aspirations.

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